GBA Fire Emblem-Style Tactical RPG — Complete Asset Checklist

> A granular, shopping-ready list of every asset category you'll need. Use this as your tracker so you don't get lost browsing. Check items off as you source them.

Where to Shop (Beyond itch.io)

Marketplace	URL	Notes
itch.io	itch.io/game-assets	Largest indie pixel art selection. Tags: `pixel-art`, `tactical-rpg`, `gameboy-advance`
Unity Asset Store	assetstore.unity.com/2d	Search "pixel art RPG." Notable: "Pixel Art UI (Gothic, RPG, Fantasy)" by SpellSoft, "80+ RPG Pixel Characters" by Jason Perry
OpenGameArt.org	opengameart.org	CC0/CC-BY licensed. Great for tilesets, LPC sprites, sound effects. Search "tactical," "RPG tiles," "chiptune"
CraftPix.net	craftpix.net (+ craftpix.net/freebies)	Polished premium + free 2D assets: GUI, tilesets, icons, characters, backgrounds
GameDev Market	gamedevmarket.net/category/2d	Curated paid packs, often Time Fantasy / finalbossblues style
Kenney.nl	kenney.nl/assets	60,000+ CC0 assets. More modern/clean style than GBA, but great for UI elements, fonts, and prototyping
game-icons.net	game-icons.net	4,000+ free SVG icons (skills, items, status effects). Monochrome but recolorable
Lospec	lospec.com/palette-list	GBA-accurate color palettes to keep your sourced assets visually consistent

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1. CHARACTER SPRITES (Map/Overworld Units)

These are the small sprites that represent units on the tactical grid.

1.1 Player Units — Map Sprites

- [ ] Lord / Main character (idle, selected/bounce)
- [ ] Cavalier / Paladin (mounted, idle, selected)
- [ ] Knight / General (heavy armor, idle, selected)
- [ ] Myrmidon / Swordmaster (idle, selected)
- [ ] Mercenary / Hero (idle, selected)
- [ ] Fighter / Warrior (axe user, idle, selected)
- [ ] Archer / Sniper (idle, selected)
- [ ] Mage / Sage (idle, selected)
- [ ] Cleric / Bishop (idle, selected)
- [ ] Thief / Assassin (idle, selected)
- [ ] Pegasus Knight / Falcon Knight (flying mount, idle, selected)
- [ ] Wyvern Rider / Wyvern Lord (flying mount, idle, selected)
- [ ] Troubadour / Valkyrie (mounted healer, idle, selected)
- [ ] Dancer / Bard (idle, selected)
- [ ] Pirate / Berserker (idle, selected)
- [ ] Monk / Shaman / Druid (dark magic, idle, selected)
- [ ] Trainee / Villager (idle, selected)

1.2 Enemy Units — Map Sprites

- [ ] Generic soldier (lance)
- [ ] Generic fighter (axe)
- [ ] Generic mage (dark robes)
- [ ] Generic archer
- [ ] Generic knight (armored)
- [ ] Generic cavalier
- [ ] Boss variants (larger or recolored versions of the above)
- [ ] Monster units if applicable (revenants, mogalls, gargoyles, etc.)

1.3 NPC / Ally Units — Map Sprites

- [ ] Green-tinted recolors of player classes OR unique NPC sprites
- [ ] Villagers / civilians (for rescue/escort missions)

1.4 Map Sprite Animations (per unit)

- [ ] Idle / breathing
- [ ] Selected / bouncing
- [ ] Movement (walking in 4 directions)

- [ ] Waiting / greyed out (turn spent)
- [ ] Death / fade out

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2. CHARACTER SPRITES (Battle / Combat Animations)

The close-up side-view battle scenes when units attack each other.

2.1 Melee Classes — Battle Animations

For EACH melee class you need:

- [ ] Idle stance
- [ ] Attack windup
- [ ] Attack strike (sword slash, lance thrust, axe swing)
- [ ] Critical hit attack (dramatic, longer sequence)
- [ ] Dodge / evade
- [ ] Damage taken / hit reaction
- [ ] Death / collapse
- [ ] Spell / item use pose (for vulneraries, etc.)

2.2 Ranged Classes — Battle Animations

- [ ] Archer: draw, release, idle
- [ ] Mage: casting pose, channel, release spell
- [ ] Sniper: crit animation (arrow barrage)
- [ ] Shaman/Druid: dark magic casting variant

2.3 Mounted Classes — Battle Animations

- [ ] Horse idle, charge, retreat
- [ ] Pegasus hover, swoop attack
- [ ] Wyvern hover, dive attack
- [ ] Rider attack synced with mount

2.4 Boss / Special — Battle Animations

- [ ] Unique boss attack animations
- [ ] Unique lord critical / special skill animations

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3. CHARACTER PORTRAITS

Dialogue box portraits shown during story/conversations and unit info screens.

3.1 Main Cast Portraits

For each named character:

- [ ] Neutral expression (default)
- [ ] Happy / smiling
- [ ] Angry / determined
- [ ] Sad / worried
- [ ] Surprised / shocked
- [ ] Injured / pained (optional)
- [ ] Blush (optional, for supports)

3.2 Generic / Enemy Portraits

- [ ] Generic soldier portrait
- [ ] Generic bandit portrait
- [ ] Generic mage portrait
- [ ] Generic villager (male)
- [ ] Generic villager (female)
- [ ] Boss portraits (unique per chapter boss)

3.3 Portrait Specs

- [ ] GBA FE portraits are roughly 96×80 px (face) with a 32×32 mini portrait for menus
- [ ] Each portrait needs a matching mini-portrait / chibi for the unit info sidebar

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4. TILESETS (Battle Maps)

4.1 Terrain Types

- [ ] Plains / grass (multiple variants)
- [ ] Forest (light, dense)
- [ ] Mountain / hills
- [ ] Desert / sand
- [ ] Snow / ice
- [ ] Water (river, ocean, lake) — animated
- [ ] Swamp / marsh
- [ ] Road / path (dirt, cobblestone)

- [ ] Bridge (wood, stone)
- [ ] Cliffs / elevation edges
- [ ] Lava / volcanic terrain (if applicable)

4.2 Structures

- [ ] Castle walls (outer, inner, corners, gates)
- [ ] Castle floor / interior tiles
- [ ] Houses / village buildings
- [ ] Shops (weapon shop, item shop, arena)
- [ ] Throne / seize point
- [ ] Forts / defensive tiles
- [ ] Ruins
- [ ] Church / temple
- [ ] Breakable walls
- [ ] Doors (open, closed, locked)
- [ ] Chests (open, closed)
- [ ] Stairs

4.3 Decorative / Props

- [ ] Trees (various biomes)
- [ ] Rocks / boulders
- [ ] Fences / hedges
- [ ] Gravestones
- [ ] Barrels, crates
- [ ] Signposts
- [ ] Torches / lanterns (animated flame)
- [ ] Banners / flags
- [ ] Market stalls
- [ ] Wells
- [ ] Statues

4.4 World Map Tiles (if you have a chapter-select overworld)

- [ ] Landmass / continent shapes
- [ ] Mountains (overworld scale)
- [ ] Forests (overworld scale)
- [ ] Rivers / coastline
- [ ] Towns / cities (overworld icons)
- [ ] Castles (overworld icons)

- [ ] Path / route lines (animated dot)
- [ ] Chapter marker / current position indicator
- [ ] Clouds / fog of war

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5. BATTLE SCENE BACKGROUNDS

The backgrounds behind the combat animation close-ups.

- [ ] Plains / open field
- [ ] Forest interior
- [ ] Castle interior
- [ ] Castle wall / battlements
- [ ] Mountain pass
- [ ] Desert dunes
- [ ] Snowy field
- [ ] Bridge
- [ ] Village / town
- [ ] Throne room
- [ ] Night variants of all the above
- [ ] Boss arena / dark void (for final bosses)

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6. WEAPONS & ITEMS (Icons)

6.1 Weapon Icons

- [ ] Iron / Steel / Silver Sword
- [ ] Iron / Steel / Silver Lance
- [ ] Iron / Steel / Silver Axe
- [ ] Iron / Steel / Silver Bow
- [ ] Fire / Thunder / Wind tome
- [ ] Light magic tome
- [ ] Dark magic / Elder magic tome
- [ ] Legendary / Unique weapons (e.g., your game's Durandal/Falchion equivalent)
- [ ] Knife / dagger
- [ ] Javelin / hand axe (ranged melee variants)
- [ ] Ballista bolt (if siege weapons exist)
- [ ] Broken weapon icon

6.2 Staff Icons

- [ ] Heal staff
- [ ] Mend staff
- [ ] Physic staff (ranged heal)
- [ ] Restore staff
- [ ] Warp / Rescue staff
- [ ] Silence / Sleep / Berserk staff

6.3 Consumable Item Icons

- [ ] Vulnerary / Potion
- [ ] Elixir
- [ ] Antitoxin
- [ ] Pure Water
- [ ] Torch
- [ ] Door Key / Chest Key / Lockpick
- [ ] Stat boosters (Energy Ring, Seraph Robe, Speedwing, etc. — one per stat)
- [ ] Promotion item (Knight Crest, Hero Crest, Guiding Ring, etc.)
- [ ] Special story items / quest items

6.4 Equipment / Accessory Icons

- [ ] Rings / Bands (stat-boosting equip items)
- [ ] Shields (if applicable)
- [ ] Gems / jewels

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7. UI / HUD ELEMENTS

7.1 Main Gameplay HUD

- [ ] Terrain info window (tile name, DEF bonus, AVO bonus)
- [ ] Unit info mini-window (HP bar, name, class, level)
- [ ] Turn indicator banner ("Player Phase" / "Enemy Phase")
- [ ] Phase transition animation / swoosh effect
- [ ] Cursor (grid selector — idle, confirm, cancel animations)
- [ ] Movement range overlay (blue tiles)
- [ ] Attack range overlay (red tiles)
- [ ] Assist / heal range overlay (green tiles)
- [ ] Danger zone overlay (purple/orange tiles)

- [ ] Grid lines (optional toggle)

7.2 Menus & Windows

- [ ] Main menu background / title screen
- [ ] Menu window frame (9-slice scalable border)
- [ ] Menu highlight / selector bar
- [ ] Scrollbar (if menus overflow)
- [ ] Action menu (Attack, Items, Wait, Trade, etc.)
- [ ] Unit stats screen background and layout
- [ ] Inventory screen layout
- [ ] Weapon triangle display graphic (Sword > Axe > Lance > Sword)
- [ ] Battle forecast window (your unit vs enemy preview)
- [ ] Trade screen layout
- [ ] Supply / convoy screen layout
- [ ] Options / settings menu
- [ ] Save / load screen layout
- [ ] Chapter title card frame
- [ ] Victory / defeat screen

7.3 Dialogue System

- [ ] Text box / dialogue window (9-slice frame)
- [ ] Name plate (character name background)
- [ ] Text advance indicator (bouncing arrow)
- [ ] Choice selection highlight
- [ ] Narration window variant (different style from dialogue)

7.4 Battle UI

- [ ] HP bar (in combat scene — both units)
- [ ] Weapon name display
- [ ] Hit%, Crit%, Damage preview numbers
- [ ] Damage numbers (floating, combat scene)
- [ ] "Miss" text graphic
- [ ] "Critical" flash / banner
- [ ] Experience bar fill animation
- [ ] Level up screen background
- [ ] Stat-up arrows / indicators
- [ ] Stat labels (HP, STR, MAG, SKL, SPD, LCK, DEF, RES)

7.5 Fonts

- [ ] Main dialogue font (GBA pixel style, ~8px or ~16px)
- [ ] Menu / UI font (may be the same)
- [ ] Damage number font (bold, battle scene)
- [ ] Title / header font (chapter titles, menus)

7.6 Icons — Status & Misc

- [ ] Weapon type icons (sword, lance, axe, bow, anima, light, dark, staff)
- [ ] Movement type icons (foot, mounted, flying, armored) (optional)
- [ ] Status effect icons (poisoned, sleeping, silenced, berserked, petrified)
- [ ] Affinity / element icons (fire, ice, wind, thunder, light, dark, anima)
- [ ] Support rank icons (C, B, A, S)
- [ ] Star rating / rank icons (for chapter clear screen)
- [ ] Arrow icons (menu navigation)
- [ ] Button prompt icons (A, B, Start, Select — or your game's equivalents)

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8. VFX / SPELL & COMBAT EFFECTS

8.1 Weapon Hit Effects

- [ ] Sword slash (1-2 frame slash arc)
- [ ] Lance stab impact
- [ ] Axe chop impact
- [ ] Arrow hit
- [ ] Critical hit slash (bigger, flashier)
- [ ] Screen flash / white flash (on crit)
- [ ] Spark / metal clash (weapon clang)

8.2 Magic Spell Effects

- [ ] Fire spell (fireball travel + explosion on hit)
- [ ] Thunder spell (lightning bolt strike)
- [ ] Wind spell (blade / tornado)
- [ ] Light magic beam / pillar
- [ ] Dark magic orb / vortex
- [ ] Heal effect (green sparkles / glow)
- [ ] Status staff effect (sleep mist, silence ring, warp glow)
- [ ] Legendary weapon special effects

8.3 Misc VFX

- [ ] Level up glow / light pillar
- [ ] Stat-up sparkle
- [ ] Promotion transformation effect (class change)
- [ ] Unit death / shatter / fade
- [ ] Poison tick effect (purple bubbles)
- [ ] Critical hit screen shake
- [ ] Chapter start text fade-in
- [ ] Map cursor glow / pulse
- [ ] Chest opening sparkle
- [ ] Door opening animation

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9. SOUND EFFECTS

9.1 UI / Menu Sounds

- [ ] Cursor move (soft blip)
- [ ] Confirm / select (bright ding)
- [ ] Cancel / back (soft thud)
- [ ] Menu open
- [ ] Menu close
- [ ] Page flip / tab switch
- [ ] Error / denied buzz
- [ ] Text scroll / typewriter (per character or blip)
- [ ] Text advance (next line)
- [ ] Save confirm jingle
- [ ] Gold / money sound (buy/sell)

9.2 Combat Sounds

- [ ] Sword swing (whoosh)
- [ ] Sword hit (clang/slash)
- [ ] Lance thrust (whoosh, different pitch)
- [ ] Lance hit
- [ ] Axe swing (heavier whoosh)
- [ ] Axe hit (thunk)
- [ ] Arrow release (twang)
- [ ] Arrow hit (thwip)

- [ ] Fist / unarmed hit
- [ ] Miss / dodge (whoosh past)
- [ ] Critical hit impact (heavier, with flash)
- [ ] Shield block (if applicable)
- [ ] Damage taken grunt (male, female variants)
- [ ] Death cry / collapse (male, female variants)
- [ ] Armor rattle (knight movement)
- [ ] Horse gallop (cavalier attack)
- [ ] Pegasus / wyvern wing flap

9.3 Magic Sounds

- [ ] Fire spell casting + impact
- [ ] Thunder bolt crash
- [ ] Wind spell whoosh
- [ ] Light magic chime / hum
- [ ] Dark magic rumble / drone
- [ ] Heal spell sparkle
- [ ] Staff use chime
- [ ] Warp / teleport whoosh
- [ ] Status effect applied (sleep, silence, etc.)

9.4 Map / Field Sounds

- [ ] Unit move on grass
- [ ] Unit move on stone / castle
- [ ] Unit move on sand
- [ ] Unit move in water / marsh (squelch)
- [ ] Chest open
- [ ] Door open
- [ ] Village visit chime
- [ ] Seize / capture jingle
- [ ] Reinforcement warning (enemy appear)
- [ ] Turn change swoosh

9.5 Jingles (short stingers)

- [ ] Level up fanfare (~2 sec)
- [ ] Stat increase blip (per stat)
- [ ] Promotion fanfare (~3 sec)
- [ ] Chapter clear fanfare

- [ ] Item obtained jingle
- [ ] Game over sting
- [ ] Support rank up jingle
- [ ] Boss defeated sting

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10. MUSIC

10.1 Map / Battle Music

- [ ] Player phase theme (main, loop)
- [ ] Enemy phase theme (tense, shorter loop)
- [ ] Ally / NPC phase theme (optional)
- [ ] Boss battle theme
- [ ] Final boss theme
- [ ] Preparations / pre-battle music
- [ ] Victory music (chapter clear)
- [ ] Defeat / game over music
- [ ] Recruitment theme (when a unit joins mid-battle)

10.2 Story / Cutscene Music

- [ ] Main title theme
- [ ] Prologue / narration theme (calm, epic)
- [ ] Dialogue theme — lighthearted / comedic
- [ ] Dialogue theme — serious / dramatic
- [ ] Dialogue theme — sad / emotional
- [ ] Dialogue theme — tension / suspicion
- [ ] Villain / antagonist theme
- [ ] Romance / support theme (optional)
- [ ] Flashback / memory theme

10.3 Menu / Ambient Music

- [ ] Main menu / file select music
- [ ] World map theme
- [ ] Shop / armory music
- [ ] Base / barracks theme (if applicable)
- [ ] Credits music
- [ ] Sound room / extras music (optional)

10.4 Music Specs

- [ ] Target: GBA-era sound (16-bit chiptune / tracker / SNES-style instrumentation)
- [ ] All tracks should loop seamlessly
- [ ] Recommended format: OGG or WAV

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11. CUTSCENE / STORY ASSETS

- [ ] CG illustrations (key story moments — optional, FE7/8 had a few)
- [ ] Opening cinematic frames (if doing a visual intro)
- [ ] Chapter intro text / scroll background
- [ ] Flashback vignette overlay (sepia / darkened frame)
- [ ] Map panning / camera movement markers (for in-engine cutscenes)

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12. MISCELLANEOUS

12.1 Title Screen

- [ ] Logo / game title art
- [ ] Title screen background illustration or animated scene
- [ ] "Press Start" blinking text
- [ ] File select screen elements (save slot frames, character preview)

12.2 Transition Effects

- [ ] Screen fade to black
- [ ] Screen fade to white
- [ ] Iris wipe (circle in/out)
- [ ] Battle transition effect (screen shatter / swipe to combat)
- [ ] Chapter transition (wipe between maps)

12.3 Particle Effects / Ambient

- [ ] Rain particles (for stormy maps)
- [ ] Snow particles
- [ ] Fog / mist overlay
- [ ] Dust motes (indoor/ruin maps)
- [ ] Firefly / ember particles (night maps)
- [ ] Screen shake effect (earthquakes, explosions in story)

12.4 Tutorial / Guide Assets

- [ ] Tutorial overlay arrows
- [ ] Highlight box / callout frame
- [ ] Hand / pointer cursor (for "tap here" prompts)
- [ ] Info / help icon

Priority Order (Suggested)

If you want to avoid scope creep and get the most visual impact fast:

1. **Cursor + grid overlays + terrain info HUD** — immediate gameplay feel improvement
2. **Map sprites (idle + move) for 4-5 core classes** — makes playtesting feel real
3. **Tilesets for 1-2 biomes** (plains + castle interior) — covers early chapters
4. **UI frames** (menu window, dialogue box, battle forecast) — the "feel" layer
5. **Weapon/item icons** for the weapons already in your code
6. **Turn phase banner + transition effects** — huge juice-per-effort ratio
7. **Core SFX** (cursor, confirm, cancel, hit, miss, level up) — audio transforms feel
8. **1-2 music tracks** (player phase, enemy phase) — the mood setter
9. **Portraits** for your first few story characters
10. **Battle animations** — these are the most work; save for later or use placeholder

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